30-DAY GIT LEARNING SERIES

GIT QUEST

LEVEL 3

The 3 Areas of Git

Week 1: First Steps | Absolute Beginner

QUEST PROGRESS: DAY 3 OF 30

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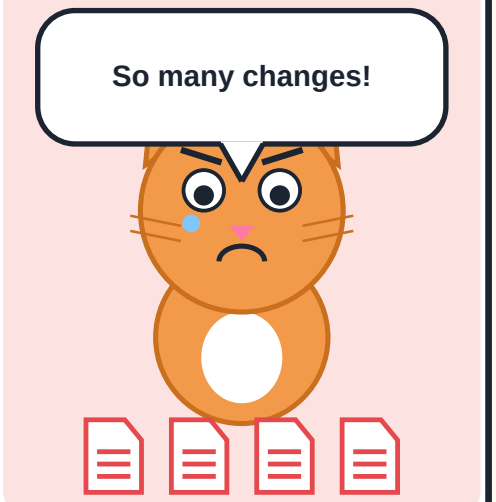
The Story: Three Places for Every File

Commit the Cat is sending a parcel. Where is the file right now?

1



The desk

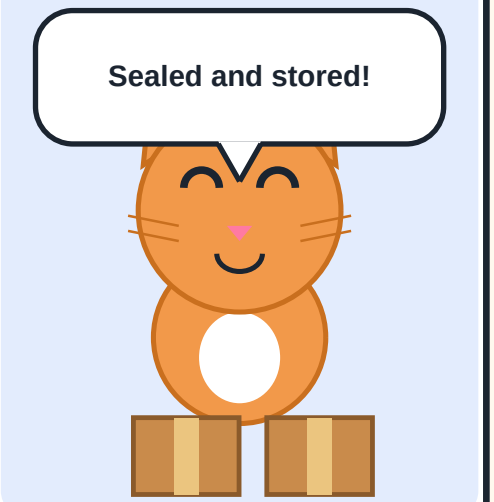
Working directory. You create and edit files here. Git notices, but saves nothing yet.

2

The packing table

Staging area. git add picks the files for the next save.

3



The cupboard

Repository. git commit seals the box and files it as a save point.

4

Why a table?

Staging lets you choose what goes in each commit, so your history stays tidy.

The 3 Areas, Side by Side

Every file lives in exactly one of these places at a time.

1 WORKING DIRECTORY

Your desk

Where you create and edit files. Git can see changes but is not saving anything yet.

git status says: Untracked, or Changes not staged

`git add`

2 STAGING AREA

The packing table

Files you picked for the next save. Also called the index.

git status says: Changes to be committed

`git commit`

3 REPOSITORY

The cupboard (.git)

Sealed save points called commits, kept safe forever.

Visible with: git log

READING git status LIKE A TRAFFIC LIGHT

Untracked files / Changes not staged

Still on your desk. Not part of the next save.

Changes to be committed

On the packing table. Ready to be sealed.

nothing to commit, working tree clean

Everything is safe in the cupboard.

Remember: add packs the box. commit seals it.

Quest Board: Move Files Between Areas

Do these inside my-first-repo, then collect 3 commits as loot.

1 Put two new files on your desk

```
$ echo "Milk, eggs" > shopping.txt
$ echo "Ideas" > notes.txt
```

2 See where they are

```
$ git status
```

Both files are untracked: still on the desk.

3 Move ONE file to the packing table

```
$ git add shopping.txt
$ git status
```

shopping.txt turns green. notes.txt stays behind.

4 Seal it into the cupboard

```
$ git commit -m "Add shopping list"
$ git status
```

Only notes.txt is left on the desk.

LOOT: TODAY'S 3 COMMITS

COMMIT 1

day03-three-areas/README.md

```
docs(day03): add lesson on the 3 areas of git
```

The lesson: desk, table, cupboard.

COMMIT 2

day03-three-areas/demo.tape

```
feat(day03): add VHS tape for staging demo
```

Script that records the terminal GIF.

COMMIT 3

exercise.md + main README.md

```
chore(day03): add exercise and update progress tracker
```

Challenge, and the tracker moves to 3/30.

Tip: each commit should tell one story. That is exactly why the packing table exists!

Boss Fight and Bonus Loot

Cheat sheet, status decoder, quiz, and your next unlock.

BONUS 1: DAY 3 CHEAT SHEET

```
git status             Which area is each file in?
git add <file>         Desk -> packing table
git add .              Pack every changed file
git commit -m "msg"    Packing table -> cupboard
git restore --staged <file>   Unpack a file
```

BONUS 2: STATUS DECODER

```
Untracked files          -> new file, Git isn't watching yet
Changes not staged        -> edited file, still on the desk
Changes to be committed   -> packed, waiting for commit
working tree clean        -> everything is saved
```

BONUS 3: DIAGRAM GITHUB DRAWS FOR YOU

````
```mermaid
flowchart LR
  A[Working directory] -- git add --> B[Staging area]
  B -- git commit --> C[Repository]
```
````

BOSS FIGHT: QUICK QUIZ

1. Which command moves a file from the desk to the packing table?
2. What does 'Changes to be committed' mean?
3. Where do sealed save points (commits) live?

Answers: 1) git add 2) The file is staged and ready to commit 3) The repository (.git)

CHALLENGE

Edit shopping.txt, run git add, then git restore --staged shopping.txt. Run git status: where did the file go?

LEVEL 4: git add and good commit messages

Unlocks tomorrow. Learn to write messages your future self will thank you for.

LOCKED